Linux formally allows AI-assisted code submissions

The Linux kernel project has formally established a project-wide policy allowing AI-assisted code contributions, marking a major shift in how open source governance is adapting to the AI era.

At the heart of the new framework is a mandatory transparency rule: AI-generated code can no longer carry the legally binding 'Signed-off-by' tag. Instead, developers must use an 'Assisted-by' tag, creating a clear disclosure trail for AI-assisted submissions.

Crucially, the policy preserves full human accountability. Any bugs, regressions, security flaws, licence issues, or provenance risks tied to AI-generated code remain the legal and technical responsibility of the human contributor submitting the patch, safeguarding DCO integrity and maintainership discipline.

The policy follows months of internal debate within the Linux ecosystem over whether AI-generated patches should be restricted. Linux creator and kernel maintainer Linus Torvalds dismissed calls for outright bans as "pointless posturing," reinforcing the project's pragmatic stance that AI should be treated as just another developer tool.

The decision also responds to growing legal concerns around licence provenance, as LLMs trained on GPL and other restrictive open source codebases may generate potentially copyright-tainted outputs.

With projects such as Gentoo and NetBSD opting for bans, Linux's disclosure-first, accountability-led framework could now emerge as a template for open source communities navigating AI-assisted development at scale.

Although no Indian firms are part of the first Glasswing cohort, local companies may still benefit indirectly as patches flow into shared open source infrastructure used across enterprise software stacks. However, Indian IT services firms remain concerned that their custom-built software environments could become vulnerable to AI-enabled attack pathways.

The Data Security Council of India has also begun industry-wide consultations, while product-led SaaS and deep-tech firms assess heightened risks that may extend into SCADA and IoT infrastructure, raising concerns beyond software into physical systems. Legacy public platforms such as Aadhaar and GST may also face elevated exposure, particularly where uneven security standards persist.

As one unnamed expert warned, "It's an entire tsunami coming in." Yet a researcher noted that "in the long term, the defenders win," even if "in the transitional period… things probably are very bad."

For Indian firms, the bigger dilemma is strategic: whether to allow a US-built LLM to audit indigenous and open source-dependent stacks or risk falling behind in vulnerability hardening.

Andhra Pradesh unveils India's first indigenous open access quantum hardware

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu dedicated India's first indigenous, open access quantum computing testbeds on April 14, marking a major shift from imported closed systems to transparent domestic quantum hardware infrastructure.

Anchored under Amaravati Quantum Valley and built through the Amaravati Quantum Reference Facilities (AQRF), the systems feature over 80 per cent indigenous components and serve as India's "first quantum hardware testbeds" for validation, certification, research, and pre-manufacturing testing.

The breakthrough is significant because India previously had no such fully built facilities.

Unlike imported platforms that function as closed 'black boxes', the new systems will allow students, researchers, and startups to directly observe hardware behaviour, conduct hands-on experimentation, and accelerate startup-led innovation—an important step in democratising quantum technology.

"This is a crucial intervention in India's quantum journey, shifting from dependence on global systems to building indigenous capability and open-access infrastructure," said P.S. Pradyumna, secretary to the Andhra Pradesh chief minister.

The first two facilities, set up by startups Qubit Force and Qubitech, are located at SRM University and Medha Towers. Backed by a seven-institution supply chain across six cities, the consortium includes Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Indian Institute of Science, and Defence Research and Development Organisation.

The initiative is expected to support applications across defence, healthcare, cryogenics, and semiconductor manufacturing, while underpinning a planned quantum hardware park and a five-year skilling pipeline targeting 4.5 million people.